

THE PROPERTY TAX PROMPT PACK

12 prompts you can paste into any AI assistant to do the busywork: the math, the tables, the letters, the drafts. You bring the facts. A human verifies every date and dollar.

How to use this pack

- 1 **Open any AI assistant.** Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Copilot. The free version is fine.
- 2 **Copy one prompt** from this pack and paste it into the chat box.
- 3 **Replace everything in RED BRACKETS** with your own information before you hit send.
- 4 **Answer its follow-up questions.** The AI will do the arithmetic, build the tables, and write the drafts.

AI tools are confidently wrong about deadlines, dollar figures, and program rules, and those change every year. Use the AI to draft and organize. Verify every date and number with your assessor, the Bergen County Board of Taxation, the NJ Division of Taxation, or your CPA before you act on it.

Privacy: it's fine to give your own AI chat and your own CPA your personal details. Please don't email them to me. I don't need your income, age, household, disability, or veteran information, and it changes nothing about how I work with you.

DO I HAVE A CASE? · PROMPTS 1-5

PROMPT 1 Run the 20-minute test

Use when: you have your assessed value (from your tax bill) and your town's equalization ratio (one call to your assessor).

COPY FROM HERE

I own a home in **[YOUR TOWN]**, Bergen County, New Jersey. My total assessed value is **[ASSESSED VALUE]** and my town's equalization ratio for this year is **[RATIO, FOR EXAMPLE 0.92]**. Do three things, showing the arithmetic step by step in a small table. First, divide my assessed value by the ratio. That is what the town says my house is worth. Second, divide that answer by 1.15, compare it with my assessed value, and keep whichever number is bigger. Call that my target number. Third, explain in plain language: if homes like mine actually sell for less than my target number, I may have a case worth filing under New Jersey's Chapter 123 rule. Use only the numbers I gave you. Do not look up or guess my town's ratio, any deadline, or any dollar figure. End by reminding me to confirm the ratio and the filing deadline with the Bergen County Board of Taxation.

PROMPT 2 Hunt for record card errors

Use when: you have your property record card in front of you. Errors here are the fastest fix there is.

COPY FROM HERE

I am checking my New Jersey property record card for factual errors. Here is what the card says about my house: **[TYPE WHAT THE CARD SAYS: SQUARE FOOTAGE, BEDROOMS, BATHROOMS, BASEMENT FINISHED OR NOT, GARAGE, LOT SIZE, ANYTHING ELSE]**. Here is what is actually true: **[DESCRIBE YOUR REAL HOUSE THE SAME WAY]**. Make a table with three columns: what the card says, what is true, and why the difference could matter for my assessment. Then draft a short, polite email to my town's tax assessor, under 150 words, listing only the factual errors and asking how to get them corrected. Do not claim any error changes my taxes by a specific dollar amount.

PROMPT 3 Organize your comparable sales

Use when: you have 3 to 10 recent sold homes from your town. Sold prices only. Not Zillow estimates, not asking prices. (Or reply to my email with your address and I'll pull them for you.)

COPY FROM HERE

I am building evidence for a New Jersey property tax appeal. My home: **[DESCRIBE YOUR HOME: TOWN, STYLE, SQUARE FOOTAGE, BEDROOMS, BATHS, LOT SIZE, YEAR BUILT, CONDITION]**. Here are recent closed sales in my town: **[PASTE THE SOLD HOMES WITH ADDRESS, SALE DATE, SALE PRICE, AND DETAILS]**. Organize the sales into a table: address, sale date, sale price, size, age, and one sentence on how each compares to my home. Then pick the 3 to 5 strongest comparables and explain each choice in one plain sentence. Use only the sales I pasted. Do not invent sales, look up prices, or estimate my home's value beyond what these sales show.

PROMPT 4 Build your condition-issue photo list

Use when: your house has problems the assessor's drive-by would never see. Photos are evidence.

COPY FROM HERE

Interview me, one question at a time, about the condition problems of my house for a New Jersey property tax appeal. Ask about things like deferred maintenance, dated kitchen or bathrooms, water problems, layout problems, the lot, and anything unpleasant next door such as a highway, train line, or commercial property. After the interview, give me three things: a plain-language list of every issue we found, a photo checklist telling me exactly what to photograph for each one, and one sentence per issue on why it could matter to the county tax board. Keep every question short and simple.

PROMPT 5 Draft your one-page hearing summary

Use when: you've done prompts 1, 3, and 4. One clean page beats a thick folder.

COPY FROM HERE

Draft a one-page summary for a New Jersey county tax board hearing. My numbers: assessed value **[ASSESSED VALUE]**, equalization ratio **[RATIO]**, the town's implied value **[ANSWER FROM PROMPT 1]**, and the value I am requesting **[YOUR REQUESTED VALUE]**. My best comparable sales: **[PASTE THE 3 TO 5 COMPS FROM PROMPT 3]**. My condition issues: **[PASTE THE LIST FROM PROMPT 4]**. Keep it under 300 words plus one small table of the numbers and one table of the comps. Formal, factual, respectful, no adjectives, no complaints about taxes in general. End with one sentence stating the requested assessment. Then tell me plainly what evidence looks weak or missing, so I can fix it before the hearing.

FILING AND TALKING TO THE TOWN · PROMPTS 6-9

PROMPT 6 Ask the assessor for an informal review

Use when: before you file anything. Many assessors will fix a clear error in one conversation.

COPY FROM HERE

Draft two things for me. First, a polite email to my town tax assessor in **[YOUR TOWN]**, New Jersey, under 120 words, asking for an informal review of my assessment before I file a formal appeal, and asking them to confirm this year's appeal filing deadline in writing. My concern in one sentence: **[FOR EXAMPLE: MY ASSESSMENT IMPLIES A VALUE WELL ABOVE WHAT SIMILAR HOMES SELL FOR]**. Second, a 60-second phone script for the same request, written the way a normal person talks, in case I would rather call. Do not state or guess any deadline date.

PROMPT 7 Request public records (OPRA)

Use when: you want your full property record card, the assessor's comps, or budget documents the website doesn't show.

COPY FROM HERE

Draft a New Jersey Open Public Records Act (OPRA) request I can email to the records custodian of **[YOUR TOWN]**. I am requesting: **[WHAT YOU WANT, FOR EXAMPLE: MY FULL PROPERTY RECORD CARD FOR (ADDRESS), AND ANY COMPARABLE SALES THE ASSESSOR USED FOR MY CURRENT ASSESSMENT]**. Keep it short, specific, and polite. Ask for electronic copies. Include my name and address block: **[YOUR NAME AND ADDRESS]**. Then tell me in two sentences who a records custodian is and how to find my town's, without guessing any names.

PROMPT 8 Decode your town and school budgets

Use when: you've downloaded this year's and last year's budgets. Your bill has three parts; find out which one actually grew.

COPY FROM HERE

I am a homeowner in **[YOUR TOWN]**, New Jersey, trying to understand my property taxes. Here are lines from my town or school district budget for this year and last year: **[PASTE THE BUDGET LINES, OR THE TOTALS FOR SALARIES, HEALTH BENEFITS, PENSIONS, DEBT SERVICE, AND LEGAL FEES]**. Compare year over year in a table: line, last year, this year, dollar change, percent change. Then explain in plain language which changes are biggest and what questions a taxpayer could reasonably ask about each. Use only the numbers I pasted. Do not fill in numbers I did not give you.

PROMPT 9 Write your budget-hearing comment

Use when: the hearing is on your calendar. Public comment is the only moment the number can still change.

COPY FROM HERE

Write a public comment for my town's budget hearing that takes 90 seconds or less to read aloud at a normal pace. I am a homeowner in **[YOUR TOWN]**, New Jersey. What I found in the budget: **[PASTE YOUR FINDINGS FROM PROMPT 8, OR DESCRIBE YOUR CONCERN IN A SENTENCE OR TWO]**. Tone: respectful, factual, no anger, no insults. Structure: who I am in one sentence, what I found in two or three sentences, and one specific question I want answered on the record. Then also give me a one-paragraph version I can email in advance so the question is on the record even if I cannot attend.

MONEY YOU MAY BE LEAVING ON THE TABLE · PROMPTS 10-12

PROMPT 10 Prepare your CPA conversation on relief programs

Use when: before your next CPA visit. Bring questions, not guesses. Your personal details belong in this chat and with your CPA, not in an email to me.

COPY FROM HERE

Help me prepare a question list for my CPA about New Jersey property tax relief. My situation, in general terms: **[FOR EXAMPLE: AGE RANGE, RETIRED OR WORKING, HOW LONG YOU HAVE OWNED THE HOME, VETERAN OR NOT, ANY DISABILITY IN THE HOUSEHOLD]**. Build me a checklist of questions covering: the statewide homeowner relief benefit and whether my filing was processed, the freeze-style reimbursement program for eligible senior and disabled homeowners, the newer state senior relief program, municipal deductions for seniors, disabled persons, and surviving spouses, veteran and disabled-veteran deductions, the deduction versus credit choice on my NJ return, my federal SALT position, and an added-assessment review if I have done permitted work. Phrase every item as a question for my CPA. Do not tell me I qualify or do not qualify for anything, and do not state dollar amounts or deadlines. Those change every year and my CPA will confirm them.

PROMPT 11 Audit your mortgage escrow

Use when: your mortgage company pays your taxes for you. Escrow errors are common and quietly cost people hundreds.

COPY FROM HERE

Walk me through auditing my mortgage escrow account, one step at a time, in plain language. I have my annual escrow analysis statement and my four quarterly property tax bills. Ask me for the numbers one at a time: what my servicer collected for taxes, what it paid out and when, and what each quarterly bill actually was. Compare them and tell me if anything does not line up. If there is a mismatch, draft a short, firm, polite letter to my mortgage servicer asking for an escrow review and a corrected analysis, and tell me what documents to attach. If everything matches, say so plainly.

PROMPT 12 Build your 12-month tax calendar

Use when: you want to stop finding out about deadlines after they pass. The AI builds the frame; your assessor fills in the dates.

COPY FROM HERE

Build me a 12-month New Jersey property tax calendar as a table with three columns: month, what happens, and who I call to confirm the exact date. Include placeholders, not guessed dates, for: the four quarterly payment due dates, the annual assessment notice, the appeal filing deadline, the informal review window before it, my town's budget hearing, my school district's budget hearing, the annual escrow analysis from my mortgage servicer, and any relief program application windows. For every single row, name who confirms the real date: my tax assessor, my tax collector, the Bergen County Board of Taxation, the NJ Division of Taxation, my school district, or my mortgage servicer. Do not fill in any actual dates. End with a list of the three phone calls that would fill in most of the table.